Cycles and Functionality in cvc5's Relations Solver

`rel.cyclic`, `rel.is-functional` and their calculus

the pull request to cvc5 main (branch `cycle-ext-cyclic`)

October 2026

Outline

1. Motivation
2. What is new compared to cvc5 main
3. The calculus
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Relational specifications need acyclicity and functionality

Axiomatic memory models allow an execution iff some union of relations is acyclic, e.g. sequential consistency: $po \cup rf \cup co \cup fr$ is acyclic.
Alloy-style specifications constrain relations to be (partial) functions.

In cvc5 main both properties must be stated with quantifiers:

$$\forall x.\ (x, x) \notin TC(R)$$
$$\forall x\, y\, z.\ (x, y) \in R \wedge (x, z) \in R \Rightarrow y = z$$

and the negation of acyclicity needs an existential witness. Instantiation (E-matching or finite model finding) has to find the right instances.

With this PR, two predicates that the relations solver reasons about directly:

```
; a forbidden execution: a cycle
(assert (rel.cyclic
  (set.union po (set.union rf
    (set.union co fr)))))
; po is acyclic and functional
(assert (not (rel.cyclic po)))
(assert (rel.is-functional po))
```

No quantifier for acyclicity or functionality; a calculus of inference rules instead (this talk).

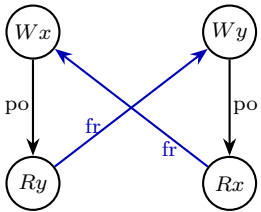
The benchmarks: completeness of litmus-test templates

13 memory-model benchmarks (relational-solver-benchmarks): SC, SC per location (plsc), TSO; one and two threads; variants `just-rf` and `no-ltts`.

Each asks: *is there an execution that violates the memory model but that no litmus-test template forbids?*

- `unsat`: the templates are complete (10 files);
- `sat`: cvc5 prints such an execution (3 files).

The violation is a cycle: `(rel.cyclic (set.union po rf co fr))`; the templates and the model are acyclicity and functionality constraints on the derived relations.



store buffering: a cycle of po ∪ fr, forbidden by SC

The changes at a glance

component	change
kinds, API	`RELATION_CYCLIC` (`rel.cyclic`), `RELATION_IS_FUNCTIONAL` (`rel.is-functional`), `RELATION_RCLOSURE`, `RELATION_RTCLOSURE` (`rel.rclosure`, `rel.rtclosure`); parser, printer, CPC signature
type rules	a binary relation whose columns have the same sort (cyclic, closures); any binary relation (functional)
rewriter	evaluation and elimination rules (constants, empty set, singletons, unions)
relations solver	the calculus: cycle witness, minimality, acyclicity, anchors, closure induction, functionality, lazy closure splits, grounding conflicts
strategy	a new full-effort step, three last-call steps, `needsCheckLastEffort`
options	`--rels-functional-mode`, `--rels-acyclic-anchor`, `--rels-acyclic-backward-chords`, `--rels-tc-subset`, `--rels-tc-down-lazy`, `--rels-acyclic-hammer`
defaults	MiniSat under `--sets-exp` (justification heuristic), except for sygus-style problems
fixes	closure rules (edge explanations, conclusions on the tuple of the explanation); no redundant facts in the sets solver
tests, docs	53 regression files; `docs/theories/sets-and-relations.rst`

Against cvc5 main (a3f47bdffd): 28 source files, +3305/ − 131 lines; tests +1958 lines.
`scripts/` (experiment scripts, these slides) is temporary.

New predicates

`(rel.cyclic R)`, R : `(Relation T T)`

$$\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \iff \exists x.\ (x, x) \in R^+$$

Acyclicity is `(not (rel.cyclic R))`.

e.g. `(rel.cyclic (set.union R S))` holds for $R = \{(a, b)\}$, $S = \{(b, a)\}$; `(rel.cyclic R)` and `(rel.cyclic S)` do not.

`(rel.is-functional R)`, R : `(Relation T1 T2)`

$$\mathsf{fun}(R) \iff \forall x\, y\, z.\ (x, y), (x, z) \in R \Rightarrow y = z$$

Right-unique, not necessarily total.

`(rel.rclosure R)`, `(rel.rtclosure R)`

R plus (x, x) for every x in its domain or range; and that union with R^+. Eliminated by rewriting when R is built from $\emptyset$, singletons and unions; otherwise the solver answers `unknown`.

Why a predicate and not a definition?
The definitions need a quantifier (or the universe set, which cvc5 does not interpret as all elements). As predicates, the solver builds *witnesses* and *explanations* for them, and uses their structure (unions, closures, joins) in its rules.

Rewrite rules: what holds in every context

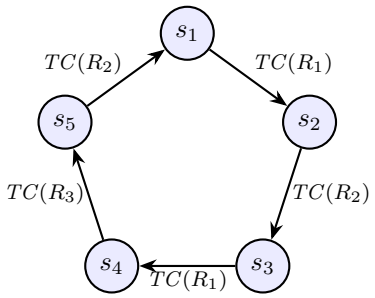
The rewriter only replaces a term by an *equivalent* term, independently of the assertions:

term	rewritten to	why
`(rel.cyclic ∅)`	`false`	no pair at all
`(rel.cyclic {(x,y)})`	`(= x y)`	only a self-loop
`(rel.cyclic` c`)`, c constant	`true` / `false`	evaluate c^+
`(rel.is-functional X)`, X: ∅, `{t}`, `(rel.iden A)`	`true`	at most one image
`(rel.is-functional` c`)`, c constant	`true` / `false`	first components
`(rel.rclosure {(x,y)})`	$\{(y,y)\} \cup (\{(x,x)\} \cup \{(x,y)\})$	definition
`(rel.rclosure (set.union A B))`	`(rel.rclosure A)` ∪ `(rel.rclosure B)`	union
`(rel.rtclosure R)`	`(rel.rclosure R)` ∪ `(rel.tclosure R)`	definition

Everything else is done by *inference rules* in the relations solver (next section).

Notation

- A configuration: the asserted literals and the equivalence classes of the equality engine; $t \sim t'$: equal in the current context.
- A rule $\dfrac{P_1 \quad \dots \quad P_n}{C}$ sends the *lemma* $P_1 \wedge \dots \wedge P_n \Rightarrow C$, a valid clause whose premises are the explanation (used by conflict analysis, unsat cores and proofs).
- Fresh symbols are skolems, cached by their key, so each is created once.
- The *cycle witness* of $\mathsf{cyclic}(R_1 \cup \dots \cup R_k)$: elements $s_1, \dots, s_l$ with $s_l = s_1$ ($l - 1$ edges), each edge in some $TC(R_j)$.



$l = 6,\ s_6 = s_1$

Cyclicity: creating and unrolling the witness

For an asserted $\mathsf{cyclic}(R)$ (fresh s, s_1, l, s_{i+1}):

$$\frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \quad R \text{ not a union}}{(s,s) \in TC(R)}\ \textsc{Cycle-Def} \qquad \frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R_1 \cup \cdots \cup R_k)}{1 < l}\ \textsc{Inst-Cycle}$$

$$\frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \quad i < l}{(s_i, s_{i+1}) \in TC(R_1) \ \vee \ \ldots \ \vee \ (s_i, s_{i+1}) \in TC(R_k)}\ \textsc{Unroll}$$

$$\frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \quad i \leq l}{i < l \ \vee \ (l = i \wedge s_i = s_1)}\ \textsc{Split-Len} \qquad \frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R') \quad R' \text{ has the operands of } R}{\mathsf{cyclic}(R)}\ \textsc{Same-Operands}$$

- The operands of nested unions are flattened: the witness of $\mathsf{cyclic}(rf \cup (po \cup co))$ alternates between $TC(rf)$, $TC(po)$, $TC(co)$.
- One Unroll per check round; at last call the witness is completed to the value of l in the candidate model.

Minimality: the witness is a shortest cycle

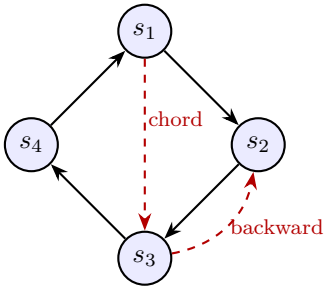
A shortest cycle of $TC(R_1) \cup \cdots \cup TC(R_k)$ exists whenever a cycle does, so the witness can be assumed shortest (for $q < r \leq l$, every R_j):

$$\frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \quad i < l}{\neg\big((s_{i-1}, s_i) \in TC(R_j) \wedge (s_i, s_{i+1}) \in TC(R_j)\big)}\ \textsc{Alternate}$$

$$\frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \quad r \leq l \quad q < r - 1 \quad (q, r) \neq (1, l)}{(s_q, s_r) \notin TC(R_j)}\ \textsc{Chord}$$

$$\frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \quad r \leq l \quad (q, r) \neq (1, l)}{s_q \neq s_r}\ \textsc{Distinct}$$

Backward (`--rels-acyclic-backward-chords`): $(s_r, s_q) \notin TC(R_j)$ if it closes a shorter cycle. It lets a totality axiom (e.g. *po* within a thread) bound the length of the witness.



$l = 5$: both dashed edges would give a shorter cycle

Acyclicity

For an asserted $\neg\mathsf{cyclic}(u)$:

$$\frac{(a,b) \in TC(R) \qquad \neg\mathsf{cyclic}(u) \qquad u \sim R}{a \neq b}\ \textsc{Acyclic-Down} \qquad\qquad \frac{\neg\mathsf{cyclic}(u)}{u \subseteq TC(u)}\ \textsc{Register}$$

- Acyclic-Down turns every reflexive closure membership into a conflict. The existing closure rules produce those memberships:

$$\frac{(a,b) \in R \qquad (b,c) \in TC(R)}{(a,c) \in TC(R)}\ \text{TC-Up}$$

$$\frac{(a,b) \in TC(R)}{(a,b) \in R \vee \big((a,k_1),(k_2,b) \in R \wedge (k_1 = k_2 \vee (k_1,k_2) \in TC(R))\big)}\ \text{TC-Down}$$

- Register is valid and does nothing logically: it makes $TC(u)$ a term of the solver even if the input never mentions it, so that a cycle of u is found.
- The conclusion is stated on the tuple of the explanation, not on its representative (the lemma is context-independent).

Cyclic meets acyclic: anchor rules

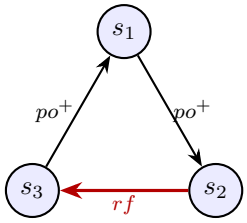
A cycle of R all of whose edges lie in $TC(S)$ would be a cycle of S:

$$\frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \qquad \neg\mathsf{cyclic}(S)}{t \in R' \wedge t \notin TC(S)}\ \textsc{Inclusion}$$

$$\frac{\mathsf{cyclic}(R) \qquad \neg\mathsf{cyclic}(S) \qquad l = N}{\bigvee_{i<N}(s_i, s_{i+1}) \notin TC(S)}\ \textsc{Branch}$$

t fresh; R': the operands of R *not* syntactically in $TC(S)$ (e.g. $S \cap Y$, $TC(S)$, $S;S$ are). If there is none, the lemma is `false`.

Branch is sent at last call, with N the value of l in the candidate model; with $l = N$ in its premises the listed edges are the whole cycle. `--rels-acyclic-anchor`: `branch` (default), `inclusion`, `both`, `none`.



$\mathsf{cyclic}(po \cup rf)$, $\neg\mathsf{cyclic}(po)$:
Inclusion gives $t \in rf$, $t \notin po^+$

Closure induction (`--rels-tc-subset`)

$TC(R)$ is the least transitive relation that contains R:

$$\frac{(a,b) \in TC(R) \qquad R \subseteq S \qquad S;S \subseteq S}{(a,b) \in S}\ \text{TC-Subset}$$

The transitive supersets S recognised in the current context:

superset S	recognised by	example
$TC(X)$, R syntactically in $TC(X)$	the shape of R	$R = po^+ \cap loc$, $S = po^+$
S transitive, $R \subseteq S$ asserted	$(R \cup S) = S$ in the context	$S = A \times B$, a closure, $J; J^T$ with $\mathsf{fun}(J)$
R itself	$(R;R) \subseteq R$ asserted	co transitive: $TC(co) = co$
R itself	$R \subseteq A \times B$, $A \cap B = \emptyset$	fr from reads to writes: $TC(fr) = fr$
X, transitive	$R = X \cap Y$ or $R = X \setminus Y$	

No fresh element: where it applies, one lemma replaces an unbounded descent of TC-Down splits, each of which introduces two elements. This is what the hand proofs of the benchmarks use ("every ghb path is in po^+").

Functionality (`--rels-functional-mode`)

$$\frac{\mathsf{fun}(R) \qquad (x,y) \in S \qquad S \sim R}{y = f_R(x)}\ \textsc{Fun-UF} \qquad \frac{\mathsf{fun}(R) \qquad (x_1,y_1) \in R \qquad (x_2,y_2) \in R}{x_1 = x_2 \Rightarrow y_1 = y_2}\ \textsc{Fun-Pairs}$$

$$\frac{\neg\mathsf{fun}(R)}{(k_1,k_2) \in R \wedge (k_1,k_3) \in R \wedge k_2 \neq k_3}\ \textsc{Not-Fun}$$

- `uf` (default): a fresh function f_R; linear in the members, congruence does the rest: $(a,b),(a,c) \in R$ give $b = f_R(a) = c$. `pairs`: quadratic, no function symbol (used when the logic has no UF).
- With cardinality constraints the solver answers `unknown` (the cardinality solver may add members that are not constrained).
- Feeds closure induction: $J; J^T$ is transitive if J is functional ($J^T; J$ relates only equal elements), e.g. $\mathit{same\ location} = \mathit{address}; \mathit{address}^T$.

Splitting closures and joins: eager, lazy, or not at all

Eager (cvc5 main): TC-Down and Join-Split for every membership, each with fresh elements. With finite model finding this floods the model with elements.

Lazy (`--rels-tc-down-lazy`): TC-Down only at last call, and only for memberships that the known members of R do not explain. Unsat proofs that never unfold a closure (closure induction) introduce no element.

Not at all (`--rels-acyclic-hammer`, for unsat problems): no TC-Down and no Join-Split. At last call a membership that the known members do not explain is a conflict:

$$\frac{(a,b) \in TC(R) \qquad R = \{m_1, \ldots, m_n\} \qquad \mathit{distinct}(a, b, \text{elements of the } m_i)}{\bot}\ \textsc{Ground-TC}$$

and Ground-Join for $(x,z) \in A;B$. The distinctness premise matters: without it, the conflict for $(a,c) \in A;B$, $A = \{(a,b)\}$, $B = \{(d,c)\}$ refuted the branch $b = d$, in which the membership holds (fixed in this PR). With cardinality constraints: `unknown`.

Why inference rules and not rewrite rules?

The rewriter

maps a term to an *equivalent* term:

- the same in every context (no access to assertions or to the model);
- no fresh symbols, no case splits;
- terminating, and applied to the input and to every lemma.

It gets the rules on the term alone: $\mathsf{cyclic}(\emptyset) = \bot$, $\mathsf{cyclic}(\{(x, y)\}) = (x = y)$, constants, closure elimination.

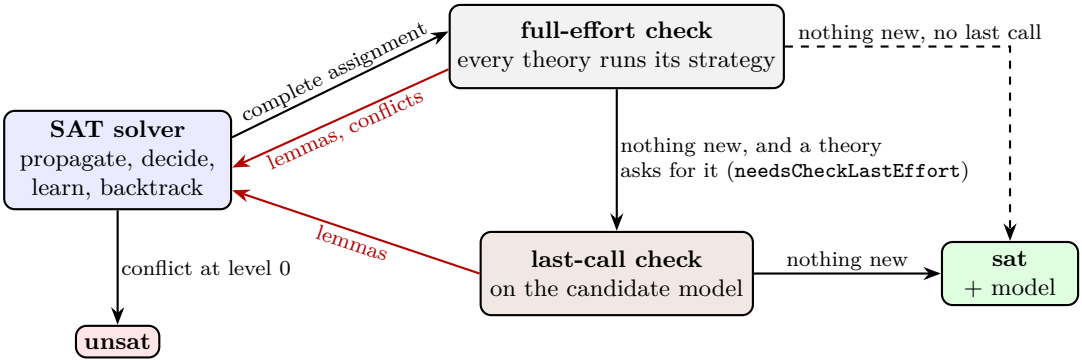
Rewriting $\mathsf{cyclic}(R)$ to its definition needs a quantifier, or $TC(R) \cap \mathit{iden}(\mathit{univ}) \neq \emptyset$, which is wrong in cvc5 (the universe is not all elements) and hides the structure the rules use.

the rules need	e.g.
a **witness** (an existential: fresh symbols)	Cycle-Def, Inst-Cycle, Unroll, Inclusion, Not-Fun
case splits for the SAT solver	Unroll picks an operand, Split-Len continues or closes
other asserted facts	TC-Subset ($R \subseteq S$, S transitive), anchors ($\mathsf{cyclic}(R)$ and $\neg\mathsf{cyclic}(S)$), Fun-UF (a membership)
equivalence classes	$S \sim R$, $u \sim R$: premises that hold now, not always
the candidate model	Branch ($l = N$), Ground-TC, Ground-Join
unbounded unfolding	a witness of any length, one element per round

Soundness

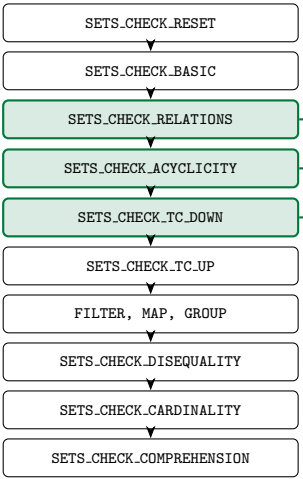
- **Valid lemmas**, consequences of the definitions and the premises: the closure rules, Acyclic-Down, Register, TC-Subset, Fun-Pairs, and the grounding conflicts (thanks to the distinctness premise).
- **Lemmas about skolems**, satisfiability-preserving: any model of the input extends to one in which the witness is a shortest cycle of the operands' closures, f_R maps every element to its image, etc. This covers Cycle-Def, Inst-Cycle, Unroll, Split-Len, Alternate, Chord, Distinct, Backward, Inclusion, Fun-UF, Not-Fun. Branch follows from them (thanks to $l = N$).
- **Incompleteness is reported**, so cvc5 answers `unknown` instead of a wrong `sat`, when
  - the length of a witness has no practical value in the model;
  - cardinality constraints meet grounding conflicts or `rel.is-functional`;
  - a `rel.rclosure` term is not eliminated by rewriting.
- **Proofs.** The lemmas are trusted theory lemmas; their CPC proofs check with ethos (`rel.cyclic`, `rel.is-functional` are in the CPC signature).

Where the rules run: cvc5's DPLL(T) loop



- The sets theory asks for a last call (`needsCheckLastEffort`) if a cycle witness exists, or under `--rels-tc-down-lazy` / `--rels-acyclic-hammer` if closures or joins occur.
- Lemmas are permanent clauses; the witness and the caches are rolled back on backtracking (context-dependent).

The sets strategy at full effort



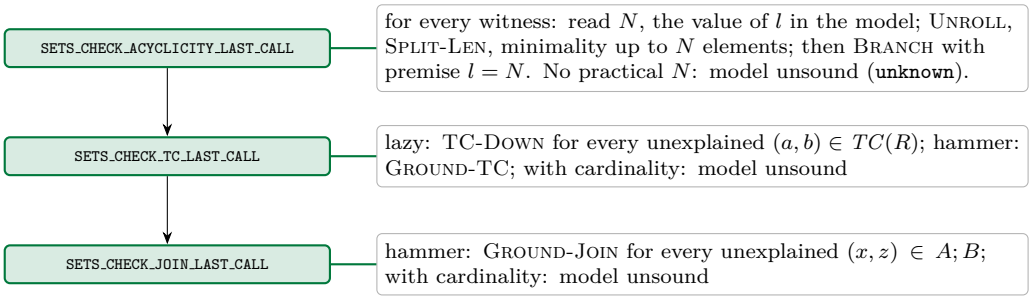
relations: collect the asserted literals and terms; CYCLE-DEF, INST-CYCLE, SAME-OPERANDS, REGISTER, NOT-FUN; per membership the join, product, transpose and identity rules, ACYCLIC-DOWN; FUN-UF / FUN-PAIRS

new step: per witness one UNROLL, SPLIT-LEN, ALTERNATE, CHORD, DISTINCT, BACKWARD, INCLUSION; BRANCH for self-loops

closures: TC-DOWN (deferred if lazy, skipped by the hammer) and TC-SUBSET per closure membership; no break: TC-UP runs in the same round

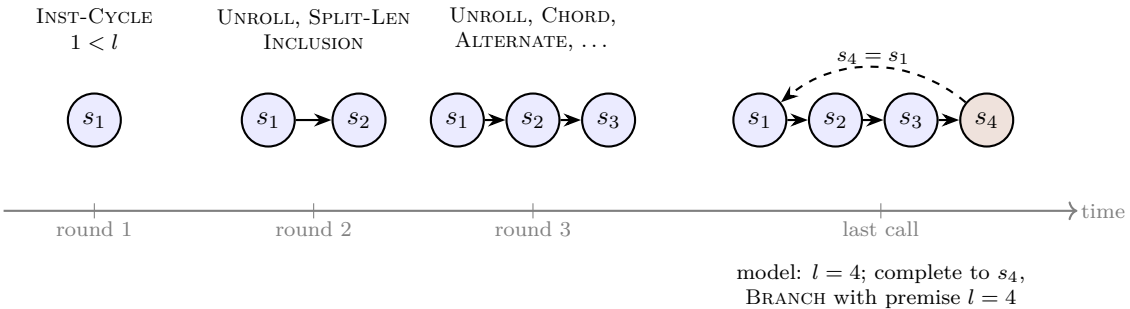
After each step (a *break*): if the step sent a lemma or a fact, the round stops. Facts only: the strategy runs again; a lemma: back to the SAT solver. Green: new or changed by this PR. TC: `TRANSITIVE_CLOSURE`.

Last call: the candidate model decides



- A step that sends a lemma ends the check; the SAT solver continues with it.
- Model-dependent rules belong here: at full effort the length of the witness is still symbolic, and the members of a relation are not final.

A cycle witness across the search



- Each round's lemmas go back to the SAT solver; a conflict may backtrack past the creation of s_3, which then disappears from the witness (and is recreated, as the same skolem, if needed again).
- A witness that is too long for the problem is refuted by minimality and the anchors; a short one survives and its edges become the model's cycle.

Options and defaults

option	default	effect
`--rels-functional-mode=uf|pairs`	`uf`	how `rel.is-functional` is used
`--rels-acyclic-anchor=branch|inclusion|both|none`	`branch`	anchor rules
`--rels-acyclic-backward-chords`	off	Backward (minimality)
`--rels-tc-subset`	off	closure induction
`--rels-tc-down-lazy`	off	TC-Down only at last call
`--rels-acyclic-hammer`	off	no TC-Down / Join-Split; grounding conflicts
`--sets-exp` ⇒ MiniSat	on	SAT solver unless set by the user or the problem is sygus-style

All six new options are expert options, off or at their previous behaviour by default. The closure rules that need them (closure induction, lazy split, hammer) win on the benchmarks only in combination (next section); turning them on by default needs a broader evaluation (e.g. on cvc5/sets-and-relations-benchmarks).

Setup

name	options (all on the files without `:finite-model-find`)
default	`--finite-model-find` (as published)
FMF	default + `--e-matching --inst-when=full-delay --rels-acyclic-anchor=inclusion --rels-acyclic-backward-chords`
noFMF	`--rels-acyclic-anchor=inclusion --inst-when=full-delay --rels-acyclic-backward-chords`
stop-only	default + `--decision=stoponly`
FMF+R	FMF + R + `--rels-tc-down-lazy`
noFMF+R	noFMF + R + `--rels-tc-down-lazy`
noFMF+H	noFMF + R + `--rels-acyclic-hammer`

R = `--prenex-quant=none --rels-tc-subset`.

- 13 benchmarks with `rel.cyclic` and `rel.is-functional` (relational-solver-benchmarks e4a4f7e), release build of the branch (45502e064c), 300 s.
- **Virtual portfolio**: every pair (benchmark, configuration) on its own, 6 at a time; per benchmark the fastest configuration counts.
- **Real portfolio**: all 7 configurations started together; the first sat/unsat wins.

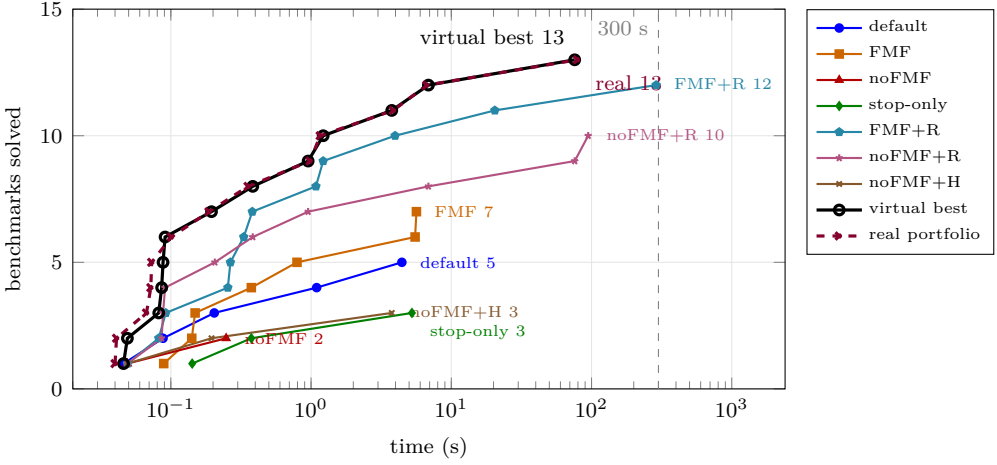
`scripts/portfolio.py` runs both modes; `scripts/slides/make_figures.py` makes the following tables and plots.

Every configuration on every benchmark (virtual portfolio)

benchmark	exp.	default	FMF	noFMF	stop-only	FMF+R	noFMF+R	noFMF+H	by	fastest
sc-1-th	unsat	timeout	unsat 0.79	timeout	timeout	unsat 0.38	**unsat 0.09**	timeout	3	0.09 s
sc-1-th-just-rf	unsat	unsat 0.20	unsat 0.15	**unsat 0.05**	unsat 5.24	unsat 0.09	unsat 0.05	unsat 0.05	7	0.05 s
sc-1-th-no-ltts	sat	**sat 0.05**	sat 0.09	unknown	sat 0.14	sat 0.05	unknown	timeout	4	0.05 s
sc-2-th	unsat	timeout	timeout	timeout	timeout	unsat 20.4	unsat 94.6	**unsat 3.76**	3	3.76 s
sc-2-th-just-rf	unsat	unsat 1.10	unsat 0.38	unsat 0.25	timeout	unsat 0.26	unsat 0.21	**unsat 0.20**	6	0.20 s
plsc-1-th	unsat	timeout	unsat 5.52	timeout	timeout	unsat 3.97	**unsat 0.95**	timeout	3	0.95 s
plsc-1-th-just-rf	unsat	timeout	timeout	timeout	timeout	unsat 0.33	**unsat 0.09**	timeout	2	0.09 s
plsc-1-th-no-ltts	sat	sat 0.09	sat 0.14	unknown	sat 0.38	**sat 0.08**	unknown	timeout	4	0.08 s
plsc-2-th	unsat	timeout	timeout	timeout	timeout	timeout	**unsat 75.8**	timeout	1	75.8 s
plsc-2-th-just-rf	unsat	timeout	timeout	timeout	timeout	unsat 1.08	**unsat 0.38**	timeout	2	0.38 s
tso-1-th	unsat	timeout	timeout	timeout	timeout	unsat 288.7	**unsat 6.87**	timeout	2	6.87 s
tso-1-th-just-rf	unsat	timeout	unsat 5.64	timeout	timeout	unsat 0.27	**unsat 0.09**	timeout	3	0.09 s
tso-1-th-no-ltts	sat	sat 4.44	timeout	unknown	timeout	**sat 1.22**	timeout	timeout	2	1.22 s
solved		5	7	2	3	12	10	3	**13 of 13**	

300 s per run. Bold: the fastest configuration, which the virtual best takes. “by”: how many configurations solve the file. 0 wrong answers. The best single configuration (FMF+R) solves 12; the portfolio solves **13 of 13**. plsc-2-th is solved by noFMF+R only.

The portfolio as a cactus plot

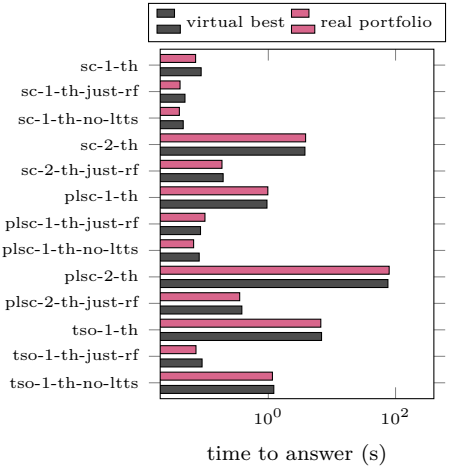


Each curve: one configuration's solve times, sorted; cumulative count; final count at its right end. Virtual best: per file the fastest configuration. Real: all 7 started together.

Virtual best versus real portfolio

benchmark	winner	VBS	real	CPU
sc-1-th	noFMF+R	0.09 s	0.07 s	0.5 s
sc-1-th-just-rf	noFMF / noFMF+H	0.05 s	0.04 s	0.3 s
sc-1-th-no-ltts	default	0.05 s	0.04 s	0.3 s
sc-2-th	noFMF+H	3.76 s	3.86 s	27.0 s
sc-2-th-just-rf	noFMF+H / noFMF+R	0.20 s	0.19 s	1.2 s
plsc-1-th	noFMF+R	0.95 s	0.98 s	6.8 s
plsc-1-th-just-rf	noFMF+R	0.09 s	0.10 s	0.7 s
plsc-1-th-no-ltts	FMF+R / default	0.08 s	0.07 s	0.5 s
plsc-2-th	noFMF+R	75.8 s	79.3 s	555.2 s
plsc-2-th-just-rf	noFMF+R	0.38 s	0.35 s	2.5 s
tso-1-th	noFMF+R	6.87 s	6.69 s	46.8 s
tso-1-th-just-rf	noFMF+R	0.09 s	0.07 s	0.5 s
tso-1-th-no-ltts	FMF+R	1.22 s	1.16 s	7.0 s

Virtual: 13 of 13. Real: 13 of 13, with the same winner on 10; real/virtual between 0.80 and 1.17 (median 0.95). Ratios below 1: the virtual runs also share the CPU (6 at a time).



Every real answer within 79.3 s. plsc-2-th needs 53 s on a fast core, 286 s on an efficiency core.

Testing

- **Regressions**: 53 new or changed files; all 443 sets, relations and bags regressions and all 2800 `regress0` tests pass with assertions on.
- **Proofs**: the CPC proofs of all 84 applicable unsat relations regressions check with ethos; `garbage_collect.cvc` times out, as on main. The check found that `rel.rclosure`, `rel.rtclosure` were missing from the CPC signature (added).
- **Fuzzing** against brute force: 5 500 random problems (`rel.cyclic` of unions, nested either way, `(not (rel.cyclic S))`, pairs forced in, out, or free) under five option sets: no wrong answer, no error.
- **Bugs found on the way, fixed in this PR**:
  - the join grounding conflict refuted satisfiable branches under the hammer (missing distinctness);
  - `rel.rclosure` of a union crashed debug builds, and of a variable answered `sat` wrongly (now `unknown`);
  - the MiniSat default answered `unsat` wrongly with `:produce-interpolants` (a latent issue, also on main with `--sat-solver=minisat`); the default now skips sygus-style problems.
- **CI**: formatting (clang-format 22, whole files) and the CPC/Logos check pass.

Contributions

- Two predicates for relational specifications, `rel.cyclic` and `rel.is-functional`, with API, parser, printer, type rules, rewrites, CPC declarations and documentation.
- A calculus for them in the relations solver:
  - a cycle witness that is a shortest cycle of the operands' closures, unrolled one element per round and completed from the model;
  - acyclicity, and anchors that connect cyclic and acyclic constraints;
  - closure induction, which proves closure memberships without fresh elements;
  - functionality by a skolem function;
  - lazy and grounded closure reasoning.
- A strategy that places each rule: context rules at full effort, model-dependent rules at last call.
- On the 13 litmus-template benchmarks: **13 of 13** solved by the portfolio (virtual and real), no wrong answer.

Where to find it

- PR to cvc5 main: `mudathirmahgoub/cvc5#17` (branch `cycle-ext-cyclic`); the same branch is `rachelcleaveland/cvc5#9`, stacked on the earlier `cycle-ext` PRs.
- Benchmarks: `rachelcleaveland/relational-solver-benchmarks`, directories `benchmarks-ltts` and `benchmarks-ltts-nofmf`.
- Temporary, to be deleted before merging: `scripts/` (portfolio runner, ablation, comparison, converters) and `scripts/slides/` (this deck, its figure generator and the run data).
- Rebuild the deck: `cd scripts/slides; python3 make_figures.py data/final-300s figures; pdflatex relations-pr.tex`.